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# Virginia House of Delegates Floor Session, Regular Session (Part 2), Wednesday, March 4, 2026

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- Official floor video (House of Delegates archive, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=q1hCgCa1Lpk
- LIS House minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/H

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**[00:15:49]** The House will come to order. The House will go at ease.

**[00:25:17]** The House will come to order. Mr. Clerk.

**[00:34:44]** Mr. Speaker, just to remind us, when last we met, we knocked out all of the third reading regular. We have communicated to the Senate, the Senate has communicated to us, there's a revenue list, and we need to get those sorted out. So we're on page 38 of today's original calendar.

**[00:35:01]** We have two HBs on second reading, which were sent down by the governor, so they're outside of time. so to speak, or the procedural resolution purposes. Then we'll go through the 38 or so House bills with Senate amendments. Then we'll go to the supplemental calendar. There is a supplemental calendar, number one, that picks up the nine bills that are on that revenue list.

**[00:35:20]** So we'll need to work our way through those, including the budget and some of the other bills that we've talked about earlier. Once we either accept or reject, then we have to communicate, assist, and accedes to get them into conference. So before we adjourn finally tonight, we have to have these nine or some variation, less than that, bills into conference because they're on the revenue list per procedural resolution.

[00:35:44] We have to have those in conference or they die. So that is where we are for another couple hours, it seems. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of a motion. Doug has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed by for the day, Senate Bill 454, I move that we reconsider that motion.

[00:36:07] It's on page 27 of the calendar. Thank you. 454. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer moves that. Having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed by Senate Bill 454, that we reconsider that motion. All those in favor say aye.

[00:36:23] Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that Senate Bill 454 be referred back to the Committee on County, Cities, and Towns. Delegate from Fairfax, Mr. Hemmer moves that Senate Bill 454 be re-referred back to the Committee on County, Cities, and Towns.

[00:36:42] All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Mr. Clerk. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, therefore, top of page 38, we come to a new category, House bills. House bills on a second reading uncontested calendar.

[00:36:59] are two in this block. Top of page 38, bill before you first, is House Bill 1530. It's legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to Solid Rocket Motor Manufacturing Grant Fund. This legislation is reported by the Committee on Appropriations now before you.

[00:37:16] Delegate from Prince William, delegatorian. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1530 cardifies the MEI Commission-approved economic development project for JOLT to be a large power transformers in Henry County. The company will create 1,185 jobs and invest $301 million in Henry County.

[00:37:37] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed its third reading. And then the next bill in the block, rounding out the block, is House Bill 1531. This is legislation that also amends the Code of Virginia, this time relating to the Transformer Manufacturing Expansion Grant Fund. Again, Legislation Report Committee on Appropriation.

[00:37:54] Delegate for Prince William, Delegatory. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1531 codifies the MEI Commission-approved economic development projects for IEVO to produce solid rocket motor components in Pennsylvania County.

[00:38:11] The company will create 1,546 jobs and invest $538 million in Pennsylvania County. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading. Shall the bills be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye.

[00:38:28] Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossing past the third reading. That's the clerk. Continuing with today's calendar, page 39, new category, House bills with Senate amendments. There are 38, I believe, spread across pages 39 through 50.

[00:38:45] So top of page 39, we come first up, House Bill 19, which relates to purchase, possession, or transportation of firearm, assault and battery of a family or a household member or intimate partner. is legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you.

[00:39:01] Then from Arlington, Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB19 is the cognate to SB160, closing the dating partner loophole. Mr. Speaker, members of the body, the differences come down to commas. And since I like our comma placement better and to ensure that the bills remain identical to each other, I move adoption of the Senate substitute and ask that the members vote no to reject the Senate substitute.

[00:39:21] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the roll. Ayes. Two. Nose, 94. Ayes 2, no is 94.

[00:39:37] Senate Substitute is rejected. Next up is House Bill 40. This relates to manufacture, import, sale, transfer, or possession of plastic firearms or unfinished frames or receivers and un-serialized firearms prohibited. Penalties. Legislation originally passed the House. Let's pass Senate with Substitute, which is before you.

[00:39:54] Delegate from Fairfax. Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the Senate Amendment, so Senate Substitute is largely technical in nature. The Attorney General's Office had some recommendations for some of the code sites, to federal code as opposed to ATF regulations. I hope it's the pleasure of the body to adopt the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[00:40:15] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 64, noes 32. Ayes 64, noes 32. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 75 now before you is legislation that relates to a medical cannabis administration to terminally ill patients report.

[00:40:36] Legislation passed the House, has passed the Senate with a substitute which is now before you. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes-Gumar. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move the Senate substitute and ask that we reject the substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[00:40:54] I'm sorry. Croke will close the row. Ayes 2, noes 94. Ayes 2, noes 94. The Senate substitute is rejected.

[00:41:10] House Bill 82 is next up. This is legislation related to elections. Deadline for receipt of absentee ballots and certain other information, 5 p.m. on the third day after the election. Legislation originally passed the House. It has passed the Senate with an amendment. And that amendment from the Senate is before you.

[00:41:26] Judge from Arlington, Judge McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate amendments for HB 82 adds a delayed enactment as requested by the Department of Elections. And this now conforms my bill to a Senate cognate SB 58. And as a reminder, this bill moves the deadline for receiving absentee ballots from noon to 5. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House agree to the Senate amendment.

[00:41:43] Shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[00:41:53] Close vote. Ayes. 64, noes 32. Ayes 64, noes 32. The Senate amendment is adopted. Over on page 40, we come to House Bill 110, House Bill 110, House Bill 110 relates to firearms in an unattended motor vehicle, civil liability.

[00:42:25] The House has passed the Senate with a substitute which is before you. Delegate from Albemarle, Delegate of Law Firm. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the Senate amendment and I ask the body to reject the Senate amendment. Delegate from Fauquier, Delegate Weber.

[00:42:40] Okay. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the roll. Ayes, zero. Noes, 96.

[00:42:59] Ayes, zero. Noes, 96. The Senate substitute is rejected. Next, we come to House Bill 113, which relates to elections, offenses, soliciting or accepting bribe to influence or procure a voter registration. Penalty. Legislation originally passed the House. Substitutes passed the Senate with the substitute. Senate substitutes before you.

[00:43:16] That's from Fairfax. Dr. Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 113 has passed this body, is a bill that just stops Elon Musk or other billionaires from coming into Virginia and trying to buy elections through bribing people for voter registration. The Senate amendments simply clarify that some de minimis things like T-shirts and stuff are not included.

[00:43:35] I hope we will adopt the Senate amendments. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the roll.

[00:43:51] Ayes 91, noes 5. Ayes 91, noes 5. The Senate substitute is adopted. Next up, we come to House Bill 126, which relates to local, regional, and community correctional facilities, access to counsel for inmates.

[00:44:10] Legislation originally passed the House, it passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you. Senator from Alamoa, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 126, as it passed this body, directs the Board of Local and Regional Jails to establish clear standards for access to counsel in correctional facilities. It passes body 89 to 8. The Senate substitute adds on explicit language, granting the board the power to formulate those policies.

[00:44:32] With that, Mr. Speaker, I move that the House agree to the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the roll.

[00:44:47] Ayes 92, nos 4. Ayes 92, nos 4. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 290 is legislation related to false statements as to school division or attendant zone residency. Penalty. Legislature passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you.

[00:45:05] That's from James City County. Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House agree to the Senate substitute. I'd like to speak to that substitute. The delegate has the floor. Thank you. The Senate substitute will convert House Bill 290 into a study to determine the extent of the number of violations that occur in each school division across Virginia for inaccurate school zone residency enrollments and reconfirm that the penalty for those violations should be changed from a criminal penalty to a civil one for future false statements.

[00:45:31] So, again, I would like to move the House adopt the Senate substitute, and I request the House vote yes. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:45:53] Ayes 82, noes 14. Ayes 82, noes 14. The Senate substitute is adopted. Next, over on page 41, we come to House Bill 318, which is legislation relating to the Virginia Parole Board, powers and duties, juvenile offenders, parole procedures, and considerations.

[00:46:12] Legislation will be passed, the House has passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 318 has to do with juvenile parole and making some various reforms to our parole. I'm going to ask the body to reject the Senate amendments and send this bill into conference.

[00:46:28] Please reject. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, zero. Noes, 96.

[00:46:44] Ayes, zero. Noes, 96. The Senate substitute is rejected. We now come to House Bill 319. HB 319 would direct the Department of Elections to convene a workgroup on the implementation of back-end opt-out automatic voter registration.

[00:47:00] Bless you. Legislation passed the House. Subject passed that with a substitute, and that substitute by the Senate is before you. The delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Hernandez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The clerk summarized that bill pretty darn well. The Senate substitute is perhaps a little bit too prescriptive, so we want to keep working on this.

[00:47:19] So I'm going to move the Senate substitute and ask that the House reject it. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the roll. Ayes 0, nos 96.

[00:47:38] Ayes 0, nos 96. The Senate substitute is rejected. Next up, we come to House Bill 338, legislation related to authority of local government's service employees. Legislation which will pass the House, which will pass the Senate with amendments in the Senate amendments here before you. That's from Arlington, Declare Lopez.

[00:47:55] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill gives localities the power to provide displaced worker protections for building service employees. I believe that the amendments are really good from the Senate side, so I move that we accept the Senate amendments. Shall the Senate amendments— Mr. Speaker?

[00:48:11] The delegate from Fauci or Delegate Webber? I apologize. If the gentleman likes the Senate amendments, would the gentleman yield for a question? Would the gentleman yield for a question? The gentleman would definitely yield for a question for my friend. The gentleman yield. Since the gentleman liked the Senate amendments, can he tell us what they do?

[00:48:27] Yes. Mr. Speaker, I would say to the gentleman that the Senate has decided to take out all references to K-12 and higher education, and I'm fine with that change, and that's the only amendment that's in the bill. I thank the gentleman.

[00:48:47] Shall the bill, shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[00:48:58] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 64, noes, 32. Ayes, 64, noes, 32. The Senate amendment is adopted. Over on page 42, we come to House Bill 355, which would require the Department of Education and Consultation with the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services to develop best practices for annual mental health screenings for public school students in grades 6 through 12, utilizing evidence-based tools.

[00:49:25] School Health Service Committee study report legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with the substitute, and that substitute is before you. Senator from Chesterfield, Senator Gartner. Mr. Speaker, thank you. I move the Senate amendments and ask that we reject the Senate amendments and vote no.

[00:49:46] Should the Senate substitute be adopted? Sorry.

[00:50:00] Close the roll. Ayes 0, no's 96. Ayes 0, no's 96. The Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 401 relates to public institutions via education, other educational and cultural institutions, Virginia Museum of Fine Arts, powers of the board.

[00:50:17] Legislators originally passed the House, has passed the Senate with an amendment, and that Senate amendment is before you. Dr. Virginia Beach, I'm going to ask you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate Amendment ensures that there's no confusion regarding the VMFA's board ability to enforce existing regulations and to create or amend regulations if needed in the future, and I move that the House agree to the Senate Amendments.

[00:50:35] Shall the Senate Amendment be adopted?

[00:50:50] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 96, no, 0. Ayes, 96, no, 0. The Senate Amendment is adopted. House Bill 444, now before we relates to Uniform Consumer Debt Default Adjustment Act established. This legislation passed the House, so we passed that with amendments, and those Senate amendments are before you.

[00:51:09] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the two relatively small amendments to this bill are recommended by the Attorney General's office to avoid the appearance that the clerk was giving legal advice to litigants, and so they changed the word, you should talk to a lawyer, you may wish to speak to one, and changed the word, can't, who may be able to.

[00:51:28] I hope it's the pleasure of the body to accept those Senate amendments. I move the Senate amendments and hope that we accept them. Should the Senate Amendment be adopted?

[00:51:45] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 75, noes 21. Ayes 75, noes 21. The Senate Amendment is adopted. Page 43 of the printed calendar, we come to House Bill 462, which would direct the Board of Education and require health literacy instruction in grades 9 and 10 in the next regularly scheduled revision of the health education standards of learning.

[00:52:10] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with a substitute. The Senate substitutes before you. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The substitute directs the Board of Education to remove any duplicative or outdated health instruction when revising the standards of learning to add this new material. I move that the House accept, move these amendments and accept them, please.

[00:52:30] Should the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:52:49] Ayes 64, nos 33. Ayes 64, nos 33. The Senate substitute is adopted. Next up, we come to House Bill 494, which relates to Virginia Personnel Act hiring preference in state government, certain former federal employees.

[00:53:10] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with an amendment, and that Senate amendment is before you. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Guzman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, members of this body. I would request that we adopt the Senate amendment. It will replace the word shall with may, which was a feedback from the administration.

[00:53:29] And once again, I will move the adoption. - Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? - Thank you.

[00:53:45] - Clerk will close the roll. - Ayes 63, noes 33. - Ayes 63, noes 33. The Senate amendment is adopted. - Next we come to House Bill 505, which is legislation relating to counties, cities, and towns, members of governing body continuing personal interest in certain transaction.

[00:54:07] Legislation originally passed the House, has passed it with substitute, which is before you. - Then from Falk Hill, Delegate McCullough. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 505 was a bipartisan bill designed to address conflict of interest issues for former locality employees that are now serving as elected officials.

[00:54:24] The Senate amendments are well intended, but I think they attack the problem in a very overly specific manner. And so I moved the Senate amendments, but I asked the House to reject those amendments using the red button, and we can work it out in conference. Should a Senate substitute be adopted? You know your audience.

[00:54:42] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, zero. Nose, 94. I-0, Nose 94. The Senate substitute is adopted. I mean, rejected. Over on page 44, we come to Delegate Martinez's House Bill 518, which relates to streaming advertisement volume control, civil penalty.

[00:55:09] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with the substitute, which is now before you. Delegate from Long County, Delegate Martinez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House agree to the Senate substitute, and I would like to speak to that substitute. the delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The underlying principle of the bill remains the same. The substitute contains language around enforcement that came from the office of the Attorney General. I hope it's the will of the body to agree to the state substitute green button.

[00:55:40] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the roll. Ayes 85, no's 11. Ayes 85, no's 11.

[00:55:58] Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 521 is legislation that relates to the Virginia Marine Resources Commission, powers and duties, wetlands. Legislation originally passed the House. It was passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you. Della from Norfolk, Della Hernandez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As a reminder, this is a bill to protect Virginia's wetlands. The bill does two things. First, it codifies the no net loss standard. Then the bill also sets up a work group to help guide future wetlands policy. The Senate substitute just adds the Virginia Maritime Association to the work group and clarifies the work group's mandate. So I move the Senate substitute and ask that we vote yes.

[00:56:32] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 70, noes 25. Ayes 70, noes 25.

[00:56:48] The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 653 now before you relates to excused student absences for visitation of immediate family members, active duty military, scheduled for deployment on leave from deployment or returning from deployment outside the United States.

[00:57:04] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with an amendment, and that Senate amendment is before you. The delegate from Richmond County, Delegate Kent. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'm going to ask that the House agree to the Senate amendments. The amendment was a result of work with VDOE, which would unify state and federal school accountability systems under the Newell's school performance and support framework regarding excused absences of immediate family members who are deployed out of the United States for military reasons.

[00:57:32] I ask and move that the House accept the Senate amendment. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[00:57:46] Ayes, 95, noes, 0. House 95, no, zero. The Senate Amendment substitute is adopted. Over on page 45, we come to House Bill 667, legislation that relates to juvenile domestic relations district courts, jurisdiction definitions, petitioned by non-citizen aged 18 to 21 years for legal custody.

[00:58:11] Legislation reportedly passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with a substitute, which is before you. That is from Prince William, Delegate Martinato. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the Senate substitute and ask that we reject their substitute. And speaking to that motion, Mr. Speaker.

[00:58:29] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate raises a good point, but is, I think, not quite where we need to be to remind folks this bill. All it does is align Virginia law with existing federal regulations to protect our immigrant young adults between 18 and 21.

[00:58:49] Therefore, I think we need a little bit more time to address one of the definitions to align. And therefore, I, again, move that we reject the Senate substitute. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[00:59:11] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 1. Noes, 94. Ayes, 1. Noes, 94. The Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 690 is legislation relating to search warrant, search of place of a boat, copy of affidavit to be part of warrant and served therewith. Temporary sealing. Legislation which has passed the House, has passed the Senate with amendments, which are now before the body.

[00:59:37] Deliver from Campbell County. Deliver there. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that we accept the Senate amendment. And speaking to that, the Senate added that we, that law enforcement explained the circumstances requiring issuance of a warrant after 5 p.m. I think it's a great idea. And I move that we accept their amendment. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? Clerk will

[01:00:07] close the roll. Ayes 96, noes 0. Ayes 96, noes 0. The Senate amendment is adopted. Turning to page 46, we come to Senate Bill 728, which would require the State Board of Health to amend regulations for permanent pump and haul of sewage, agritourism. Legislation originally passed the House, so it's passed that with a substitute, which is before you. The delegate from Chesapeake, Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:00:39] As a reminder, this bill would allow agritourism businesses to pump and haul in very limited situations. And I'm going to ask the body to accept the Senate amendments, but don't get me wrong. It's not because they're smarter than we are. These ideas originated from several House members that I committed to make in the Senate.

[01:00:56] The first would limit this to Planning District 23, and the second would require these permits to be governed by the Virginia Administrative Code. And I would ask that the body accept the Senate amendments. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall a Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:01:18] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 95, noes 1. Ayes 95, noes 1. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 773, now before you, relates to elections.

[01:01:35] Absentee voting, pure process. Legislation passed the House. Southern Pass Senate with an amendment. Senate amendments before you. Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Thornton. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 773, the amendment for that from the Senate, basically enacts the date to September 1st, 2026 for the Department of Elections to have time to

[01:01:59] implement the bill. I ask that we vote yes. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? I move that we pass. Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 63, noes, 33. Ayes, 63, noes, 33. The Senate amendment is

[01:02:27] adopted. Next, a bill is HB 774. HB 774 relates to elections. This time, absentee and provisional ballots cure process. Legislation passed the House, subsequently passed that with amendment, and the Senate amendment now is for you. Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Thornton.

[01:02:46] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Similar to HB 773, HB 774, the amendment also allows the Department of Department of Elections to be prepared by moving an enactment date of September 1st, 2026. I ask that we vote yes to that amendment.

[01:03:08] Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? Close the roll. Ayes 62, noes 33.

[01:03:26] Ayes 62, noes 33. The Senate amendment is adopted. House Bill 835 is now before you. It relates to elections. Candidates and elected officials address confidentiality. Legislation will actually pass the House. Subject pass the Senate with a substitute which is before you.

[01:03:44] Delegate for Arlington. Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate substitute for HB 835 would allow, will now conform my bill to its Senate cognate SB 632 by adding a delayed enactment and a timeline to receive written consent for the release of personal information. As a reminder, this bill enhances the safety and privacy of elected officials and candidates.

[01:04:04] Mr. Speaker, I move that the House agree to the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted.

[01:04:22] Close the roll. Ayes 76, noes 19. Ayes 76, noes 19. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 836 relates to public schools' right to free public elementary and secondary education discrimination based on immigration status prohibited requirements.

[01:04:41] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with the substitute and Senate substitutes before you. Director for Royal Oak City, Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As a reminder, this bill is a bill about kids feeling safe in school. uh we are trying to align this with the senate cognate so i would move the senate substitute and hope we vote no shall the senate substitute be adopted close the roll ayes zero noes 95

[01:05:16] ayes zero noes 95 the senate substitute is rejected house bill 871 uh 871 uh relates to storage of firearms in residence where a minor or person prohibited from possessing a firearm is present penalty legislation originally passed the house of the past senate with substitute which is before you. Delegate from York County, Delegate Downey. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As the clerk identified, this is regarding safe storage of firearms in a home. The Senate substitute expands the options for loaded firearms to be stored to a coded lock, combination lock, or a biometric lock. I move the Senate substitute and encourage members to vote yes.

[01:05:53] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the vote. Ayes 60, nos 34. Ayes 60, He knows 34, the Senate's substitute is adopted.

[01:06:11] House Bill 872 relates to possession of portable electronic device in district or circuit court. Legislation originally passed House, passed Senate's substitute which is before you. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As passed by the House, HB 872 stated that the

chief judge of every district and circuit court may allow for the possession of portable electronic devices such as cell phones, laptops, or tablets by visitors to the court conditioned upon certain limitations.

[01:06:41] The Senate substitute changes the language from May to shall to ensure that all courts permit visitor devices under a defined policy set by judges and also conditioned upon certain limitations. For this reason, the substitute also removes the requirement for courts to provide storage.

[01:06:57] Mr. Speaker, I move that the House agree to the Senate substitute. Shall a Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:07:12] We'll close the row. Ayes 88, noes 6. Ayes 88, noes 6. The Senate substitute is adopted. Over on page 48, we come to House Bill 968. This is legislation-related election results, counting machine-readable ballots.

[01:07:30] Legislation originally passed the House, so it's passed Senate with a substitute, which is before you. Delegate for Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 968 mandates that all machine-readable ballots must be read by the voting machines. Includes a limited list of situations excluded and establishes processes for duplication for readability.

[01:07:50] The Senate amendment also adds a duplication process for unreadable provisional ballots and keeps the delayed enactment clause. I move that we would accept the Senate amendment, excuse me, the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:08:13] Close the roll. Ayes 63, noes 32. Ayes 63, noes 32. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 998, now before you, relates to a menstrual product's ingredient labeling, civil penalty.

[01:08:30] The legislation originally passed the House, so it passed the Senate with an amendment, which is now before you. From Fairfax, Delegate Seabold. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 998 adds ingredient labeling to menstrual supplies. The Senate amendment changes the enforcement from VDH to the Virginia Consumer Protection Act. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House agree to the Senate amendment.

[01:08:47] Shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[01:08:58] Close the vote. Ayes. 70, excuse me, I-69, Nose 25. I-69, Nose 25. The Senate amendment is adopted. House Bill 1,165 would require the Board of Education to amend its regulations relating to the qualifications of division superintendents.

[01:09:18] Legislation originally passed the House, substitute passed that with an amendment, and that Senate amendment is here before you. Delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Cole. Yes, Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1165, the amendment just changes the effective date to July 1st, 2026. And Mr. Speaker, I move the House agree to the Senate amendment. And I'd like, yes.

[01:09:38] Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 62, nos, 33.

[01:09:54] Ayes, 62, nos, 33. The Senate substitute is adopted. Over on page 49 of the printed calendar, we come to Senate bill, excuse me, House Bill 1283. 1283 relates to high school graduation requirements and diploma pathways implementation.

[01:10:10] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you. Delegate from Rockbridge, Delegate McLaughlin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask that we move the Senate substitute and accept the substitute. And I speak to that motion.

[01:10:25] The delegate has the floor. It's been a long day. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute conforms my bill to the substitute. And this, remember, is just a fairness bill for students entering into the ninth grade. It says that if they enter and they've picked their diploma path, that if the curriculum changes midway through, that they still get to stick with the curriculum that they entered into.

[01:10:49] I ask that we accept the substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:11:01] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 94, no's 1. Ayes, 94, no's 1. Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 1385, now before you, relates to gubernatorial appointments, confirmation process, Virginia Commission on Higher Education Board appointments, membership duties and committees of and legal counsel for governing boards and public institutions of higher education.

[01:11:25] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with the substitute and Senate substitutes before you. That's from Montgomery County, Delegate Franklin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. We still have some work to do to get these Senate and House versions in the same place. I move the substitute, ask the body to reject the substitute and vote no.

[01:11:41] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:11:52] Close the roll. Ayes 1, nos 94. Ayes 1, nos 94. The Senate substitute is rejected. Next we come to House Bill 1441. This legislation relates to law enforcement agencies' agreements with federal authority for immigration enforcement requirements.

[01:12:12] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with a substitute, which is now before you. Senator from Arlington. Senator Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 783 from Senator Saleem that we discussed earlier today is the same, is a similar bill to my bill, HB 1441.

[01:12:28] It's been a product of a very long stakeholder process. There's a little bit more we need to do here to finish it out, so I hope that we reject the Senate amendments and go to conference. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:12:46] Corporal close the row. Ayes, zero, nos, 95. Ayes, zero, nos, 95. The Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 1522 is legislation here that relates to nursing homes and assisted living facilities, licensure, automated external defibrillators.

[01:13:07] Legislation, of course, originally passed the House, then went to the Senate, they amended and that Senate amendment is here before you. Delegate from Fairfax, Senator McGuire. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. My bill, HB 1522, is the bill that will require AEDs to be placed in nursing facilities. It left the House with the delayed enactment date of July 1st, 2027.

[01:13:25] The Senate decided to remove that and make it enforceable beginning July 1, 2026, which was actually the original draft of the bill. I've been waiting all session to say this. There's peace in the valley. And, Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the Senate amendment and ask that the House accept that amendment. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[01:13:49] So we'll close the roll. Ayes 89, noes 5. Ayes 89, noes 5. The Senate amendment is adopted. Over on page 50 of today's original calendar, first calendar, we come to House Bill 1524.

[01:14:07] Different bill, same patron. This one relates to carrying assault firearms in public areas prohibited penalty. Legislation originally passed the House. It was passed the Senate with the Senate substitutes before you. That is from FabFax. That is McGuire. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate

substitute to my bill, HB 1524, just takes the Senate language, which is similar in policy, but different in definitions.

[01:14:27] We do need to go to conference to work these out. So, Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the Senate substitute, but ask that the House reject the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Closed row.

[01:14:46] Ayes, 0. Nos, 95. Ayes, 0. Nos, 95. The Senate substitute is rejected. And rounding out the trifecta, we come to House Bill 1525, which is legislation relating to possession or transportation of certain firearms by certain persons. Penalty. Legislation officially passed the House. Pass the Senate with a substitute, which is before you.

[01:15:03] Debt from Firefighters, Elder McGuire. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. When you get here a week late, all your bill numbers are basically the same, so I apologize about that. But the Senate substitute to HB 1525 is basically the same thing as the bill before us that we just heard. It lays the Senate version on top of mine. The policy is the same, but there are definitions we need to fix in conference.

[01:15:21] So I move adoption of the Senate substitute, but ask that the House reject the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:15:35] Close the row. Ayes zero, no's 95. Ayes zero, no's 95. The Senate substitute is rejected. Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, having voted on the prevailing side by which we failed to adopt the Senate substitute to House Bill 355 and move that we reconsider that motion on page 42 House Bill 355 page 42 we voted on the prevailing side by which we rejected those amendments and move that we reconsider that vote. I voted on the prevailing side by which we rejected the Senate amendments

[01:16:08] on House Bill 355 found on page 42. The delegate from Fairfax moves that we reconsider that vote. All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed no. The motion is approved.

[01:16:24] The motion is agreed to the delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Gardner. Yes, thank you. The bill is not up yet. Oh, sorry. Mr. Clerk. House Bill 355, now before you, we require the Department of Education in consultation with the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services to develop best practices for annual mental health screenings for public students in grades 6 through 12, utilizing evidence-based tools.

[01:16:46] There's a School Health Services Committee study and a report and legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate, and now the substitute is back before you a second time. The delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Gardner. Yes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the Senate substitute and want to speak to what the Senate substitute does. The delegate has the floor. Yes. The Senate substitute removes a pre-study report by the Department of Education, so I want to move that we accept the Senate substitute.

[01:17:18] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Thank you. Close the roll. Ayes, 63, noes, 32.

[01:17:37] Ayes, 63, noes, 32. The Senate substitute is adopted. So that completes the action in the original calendar. Now, like I said before, we have a supplemental calendar with, I think, nine bills on that.

[01:17:56] So we come first on the supplemental calendar to page one, which is House Bill 30. Ms. McMack, may I have a second?

[01:18:08] House will be at ease. House will come to order. Mr. Clerk, supplemental calendar.

[01:21:05] Supplemental calendar number one for today, Wednesday, March 4, 2026. The nine bills that are on the supplemental calendar are all have been deemed jointly by the two bodies to be revenue or budget bills impacted by today's deadline. They have to be put in conference or they die otherwise. So page one, we come to House Bill 30, the new biennial budget bill for all appropriations of the budget and to provide a portion of the revenues for the two years ending respectfully on the 30th day of June 2027 and the 30th day of June 2028.

[01:21:37] And the legislation also amends and reenacts various portions of the Code of Virginia and repeals a portion of the Acts of 2022 effective for taxable years beginning on and after January 1, 2027. Of course, the bill originally passed the House, suddenly passed the Senate with amendments, and those Senate amendments to the budget bill are now before you.

[01:21:54] Delegatorian. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, as the clerk has indicated, House Bill 30 went over to the Senate. They received a bill, slapped several Senate amendments on House Bill 30. I am going to ask the House to reject the Senate amendments.

[01:22:10] Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? Can you leave this? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, zero, nos, 92.

[01:22:25] Ayes, zero, nos, 92. The Senate amendments are rejected. Now we go to page two of the supplemental calendar. We come to House Bill 145, which is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact portions of the code, repeal several others, all relating to Fantasy Contest Act regulation and taxation.

[01:22:44] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with a substitute, and that Senate substitutes now before you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Creasy. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute to my House Bill 145 on Fantasy Sports Regulation conform my version to the Senate version, which is no one's fantasy. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the Senate substitute and vote no.

[01:23:04] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? That's right. Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. Ayes 0, noes 93.

[01:23:20] Ayes 0, noes 93. The Senate substitute is rejected. Now we come to House Bill 161, which is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact various portions of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Lottery. Casinos, Internet gaming, authorized penalties. Legislature originally passed the House, passed the Senate with the substitute.

[01:23:36] Senate substitutes now before you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the Senate substitute comes a long way towards our position. It still has a reenactment clause, but it's not quite there yet. There's a lot of things that we need to work on, so I hope that you give us an opportunity to do that in conference by voting no on the Senate substitute. Move the Senate substitute and ask the members to vote no.

[01:23:53] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:24:02] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 0, no's 94. Ayes 0, no's 94. The Senate substitute is rejected. Now we come to House Bill 400. House Bill 400 relates to motion picture production tax credit. Sunset legislation, of course, originally passed the House.

[01:24:18] So it's passed the Senate with a substitute. That's the Senate substitutes before you. From Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute makes a correction to make it in line with the Senate Bill 612 that's already on its way to the governor, making it clear what the sunset date is for the motion picture tax credit.

[01:24:36] I move that we accept the substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:24:53] Ayes. Seventy, noes, twenty-four. Ayes, seventy, noes, twenty-four. The Senate substitute is adopted. Over on page three of today's supplemental calendar, we come next to House Bill 642, which seeks to amend and reenact a wide variety of sections of the Code of Virginia, repeal a couple others, all relating to cannabis control, retail market penalties.

[01:25:18] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed that with the substitute, which is before you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cresick. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute to my House Bill 642 to establish a legal adult use retail cannabis market conformed this bill to the Senate version. We still have some more work to do. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the Senate substitute and vote no in order to send us to conference. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the

[01:25:51] roll. Ayes zero, nos 95. Ayes zero, nos 95. The substitute is rejected. House Bill 665 is Legislation is now before you relating to financial institutions and services, virtual currency, kiosk operators, license-required penalties.

[01:26:08] Legislation originally passed the House, it passed the Senate with a substitute, and the Senate substitute is now awaiting your action. From Prince William, Delegate Maldonado. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute is a reflection of an edit, a line-item amendment that we received from the Attorney General's Office that helps to adjust the CURE language.

[01:26:30] I move that we adopt the Senate substitute and say yes. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 84, noes 10.

[01:26:48] Ayes 84, noes 10. The Senate substitute is adopted. Over on page 4 of today's supplemental, we come to Delegate Hayes' House Bill 796, which seeks to, I'm sorry, HB 796, which relates to professions and occupations, adjustment of fees by regulatory boards, recovery of disciplinary and monitoring costs.

[01:27:07] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with the substitute, and the Senate substitutes before it. DELEGATE HAGUE: Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Haig. DELEGATE HAGUE: Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this substitute actually conforms my bill to the Senate version of the same bill. I ask that we adopt the Senate substitute and ask that we vote yes.

[01:27:24] DELEGATE HAGUE: Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? DELEGATE HAGUE: Clerk will close the roll. DELEGATE HAGUE: Ayes.

[01:27:41] DELEGATE HAGUE: 69, noes 26. DELEGATE HAGUE: The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 1233 relates to Virginia Sexual and Domestic Violence Victims Fund additional fee for certain offenses. Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with a substitute.

[01:27:57] Senate substitutes before you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate substitute reflects a negotiated fee. This now assesses a $500 fee on convicted

traffickers, solicitors, and other sex crimes. Those funds will go to support the Virginia Sexual and Domestic Violence Fund.

[01:28:14] I move the Senate substitute now so that we accept. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:28:30] Ayes, 95, noes, 0. Ayes, 95, noes, 0. The Senate substitute is adopted. The last bill on the supplemental is, Delegate Hayes, is House Bill 1272. HB 1272 relates to regulation of electronic gaming devices penalties.

[01:28:49] Legislation originally passed the House. The Senate passed the Senate with the substitute. The Senate substitute to HB 1272 is before you. Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this substitute actually conforms my bill to the Senate version of the bill. I ask that we adopt the Senate substitute and vote yes.

[01:29:09] Bless you. Council be at ease.

[01:29:34] Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate version and substitute of this actually conforms my bill to the Senate version, but I like the original version more, so I'd like to ask that we vote no and reject the Senate substitute.

[01:29:50] Y'all sleep around here. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[01:30:02] Close the row. Ayes. Zero, noes, 92. Abstentions, 1. Ayes, zero, noes, 92. Abstentions, 1. Good try. Ms. Speaker, so that completes the supplemental calendar. Yeah, you can explain and then I will call on her.

[01:30:21] Ms. Speaker, so we have the supplemental calendar. The Senate is in recess until 5.30. The other body, excuse me, they are ready to communicate, presumably ours. We will have what we've just done on the supplemental. We need to communicate that to them.

[01:30:37] Then we'll have to insist in a seat and get bills into conference. So we will come back and then have to announce conferees. Excuse me. Yes. So assist the seat and then announce conferees. So that's what's before the body. We're on the downhill slide.

[01:30:54] Delegate from Alexander. Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House stand in recess until 530. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring moves that the House stand in recess until 530. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The house stands in recess until 5. You got some chicken or something you run into?

[01:31:17] The house stands in recess until 5.30 p.m. You want to announce it? Immediately, so now.

[01:31:36] So over in the 12th floor appropriations, committee on appropriations will meet while we have this hour-long recess. Also, the house transportation, highway safety, and policy subcommittee will meet upon adjournment of the full committee on appropriations.

[01:31:56] They'll be in the lower level eight. Where are you going to meet? Yeah, appropriations, you're good. Go. Sorry.




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